

# Joel Schofer's Promotion Board Prep

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The views expressed in this publication are those of the author and do not necessarily reflect the official policy or position of the Department of the Navy, Department of Defense, or the United States Government.

## DEDICATION

To my wife Wendy and my children Erin and Nicholas, a supportive and understanding family, which is one key to a successful Naval career.



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## ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

The number of people who have contributed to this reference is innumerable. To all of them, I simply say, “Thank you.”





## GETTING STARTED

The first thing you need to do is download PDF copies of your Officer Summary Record (OSR), Officer Data Card (ODC), and Performance Summary Record (PSR). Follow the thick red arrows below for the step-by-step guide to get these documents.

Go to BUPERS On-Line (<https://www.bol.navy.mil/>). Click on the CAC login button.



Now click on the “ODC, OSR, PSR, ESR” link.



1  Click on any information icon to the right of a menu item to see additional information about that application.

- ADMITS
  - Advancements/Selection Boards
  - Application (FORMAN) Status
  - ARPA/RSOSH Online
  - CCAAT/ITRE/Pleal Reports
  - COC/MC Advancement/Selection Board Verification
  - Configuration Management
  - FTS Re designation
  - Individual Medical Readiness (IMR) Status
  - Military Locator System
  - Naval Register
  - NavPers Legacy and PermTEMPO
  - Navy Personnel Command Document Services
  - Navy Marine Corps Mobilization Processing System (NMDCS, OCR, PSR, ESR, ESR)
  - Official Military Personnel File (OMPF) - My Record
  - PRIMIS
  - IPTDR
  - Request Record on CD
  - Selection Board Member/Observer Training
  - Selective Reenlistment Bonus

Click on any information icon to the right of a menu item to see additional information about that application.

Record (OSR) ←

Summary (Pre-1996 Form) ←

Summary (1996 to Present) ←

**PSR PART I –** [Officer Summary Record \(OSR\)](#)  
**PSR PART II –** [Officer FITREP Summary \(Pre-](#)  
 ( PDF Version Only )  
**PSR PART III –** [Officer FITREP Summary \(199](#)

 Officer Data Card (ODC)

[Performance Summary Record \(PSR\) - Overview](#)

[Summary \(Pre-1996 Form\)](#)

**PSR PART I –** [Officer Summary Record \(OSR\)](#)  
**PSR PART II –** [Officer FITREP Summary \(Pre\)](#)  
 ( PDF Version Only )  
**PSR PART III –** [Officer FITREP Summary \(199](#)

[Officer Data Card \(ODC\)](#)[Performance Summary Record \(PSR\) - Overview](#)[Proceed to OSR](#)

A summary of the changes include:

- Dates - All dates displayed in YYMMDD format.
- Highest Flag - A new field that captures the date of rank for the highest Flag rank achieved.
- Highest CWO - (Formerly titled "Warrant") This field displays the date of rank for the highest CWO rank achieved.

Now click on the button that will download the PDF for you.

**PSR PART I ~** [Officer Summary Record \(OSR\)](#)  
**PSR PART II ~** [Officer FITREP Summary \(Pre\)](#)  
 ( PDF Version Only )  
**PSR PART III ~** [Officer FITREP Summary \(199](#)

[Officer Data Card \(ODC\)](#)

### Performance Summary Record (PSR) - Overview

Officer Summary Record ( OSR )

|                                                      |                           |                                  |                              |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <a href="#">General Data</a>                         | <a href="#">Education</a> | <a href="#">Previous Service</a> | <a href="#">Generate PDF</a> |
| <a href="#">Personal Decorations / Special Quals</a> |                           | <a href="#">Remarks</a>          |                              |

## JOEL SCHOFER'S PROMOTION BOARD PREP

You'll need to repeat these last three steps for the PSR and ODC. Then you should have the three PDF files you need. If you experience problems accessing these items online, contact the My Navy Career Center at 1-833-330-MNCC (6622) or [askmncc.fct@navy.mil](mailto:askmncc.fct@navy.mil).

## YOUR PROMOTION TIMELINE

**How Do You Know When You Will Be “In-Zone” for Promotion? When Does the Board Meet? When is Your Last Fitness Report (Fitrep) Before the Board?**

To answer these questions, follow these steps:

- Find your date of rank. It can be found in box 36 of your ODC. Here is what mine looked like, so you can see that my date of rank for CDR was 9/1/13:

| PROMOTION HISTORY |      |        |        |        |      |        |     |
|-------------------|------|--------|--------|--------|------|--------|-----|
| 36 FLAG           | CAPT | CDR    | LCDR   | LT     | LTJG | ENS    | W-2 |
|                   |      | 090113 | 020107 | 051801 |      | 012797 |     |

It can also be found at the top of your OSR in the 2<sup>nd</sup> full row from the top:

| HIGHEST FLAG | CAPT | CDR    | LCDR   | LT     | LTJG | ENS    | HIGHEST CWO |
|--------------|------|--------|--------|--------|------|--------|-------------|
|              |      | 130901 | 070201 | 010618 |      | 970127 |             |

- Look at the 2<sup>nd</sup> and 3<sup>rd</sup> columns below and find the date range that contains your date of rank. If you are Medical or Dental Corps, that is the year you will **probably** be in-zone for promotion. It is not official until the promotion zones are released. Because the Nurse

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and Medical Service Corps are [not DOPMA exempt](#) they will have to wait for the promotion zones to be released before they know when they are in-zone. In addition, if you are Medical or Dental Corps, by looking below you can find out when the board convenes and when your last fitrep will be before you are up for promotion. Note that if you have a change of command or deploy, you may have additional fitreps.

- For example, if your date of rank for CDR was 9/1/18, which is between 10/1/17 and 9/30/18, you will be in-zone for CAPT in Fiscal Year 2024 (FY24). The board meets in FEB 2023 and your last fitrep before the board was in APR 2022 (unless you have change of command or concurrent fitreps).

| FY<br>You<br>Are<br>In-<br>Zone | Date of Rank   |         | Selection Board<br>Convenes                                                                                                                       |           |           | Last Periodic Fitrep<br>Before Board |           |           |
|---------------------------------|----------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|--------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
|                                 |                |         | O4                                                                                                                                                | O5        | O6        | O4                                   | O5        | O6        |
| N/A                             | Before 10/1/17 |         | You were either already in-zone during a previous board or were not considered for promotion because you did not have 1 year of active duty time. |           |           |                                      |           |           |
| 24                              | 10/1/17        | 9/30/18 | MAY<br>23                                                                                                                                         | MAY<br>23 | FEB<br>23 | JAN<br>23                            | OCT<br>22 | APR<br>22 |
| 25                              | 10/1/18        | 9/30/19 | MAY<br>24                                                                                                                                         | MAY<br>24 | FEB<br>24 | JAN<br>24                            | OCT<br>23 | APR<br>23 |
| 26                              | 10/1/19        | 9/30/20 | MAY<br>25                                                                                                                                         | MAY<br>25 | FEB<br>25 | JAN<br>25                            | OCT<br>24 | APR<br>24 |
| 27                              | 10/1/20        | 9/30/21 | MAY<br>26                                                                                                                                         | MAY<br>26 | FEB<br>26 | JAN<br>26                            | OCT<br>25 | APR<br>25 |
| 28                              | 10/1/21        | 9/30/22 | MAY<br>27                                                                                                                                         | MAY<br>27 | FEB<br>27 | JAN<br>27                            | OCT<br>26 | APR<br>26 |
| 29                              | 10/1/22        | 9/30/23 | MAY<br>28                                                                                                                                         | MAY<br>28 | FEB<br>28 | JAN<br>28                            | OCT<br>27 | APR<br>27 |

## What Are Your Chances of Promoting?

See the tables below for the actual promotion statistics for the Medical Corps for the last 10 years:

|           | FY14 | FY15 | FY16 | FY17 | FY18 | FY19 | FY20 | FY21 | FY22 | FY23 | FY24 |
|-----------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| <b>O4</b> | 100% | 100% | 100% | 100% | 100% | 100% | 100% | 100% | 95%  | 95%  | 95%  |
| <b>O5</b> | 80%  | 70%  | 70%  | 65%  | 75%  | 85%  | 77%  | 77%  | 90%  | 90%  | 94%  |
| <b>O6</b> | 60%  | 60%  | 50%  | 70%  | 80%  | 90%  | 81%  | 91%  | 90%  | 95%  | 90%  |

**Medical Corps promotion opportunity.** This percentage is multiplied by the zone size to give the number of officers to be selected for promotion. For example, if the promotion opportunity is 60% and there are 100 officers in-zone, then 60 will be selected for promotion. This 60, however, may come from officers who are below-zone, in-zone, or above-zone. For example, maybe 35 of the 60 are in-zone, and 25 are below or above-zone. That is why the percentage of people in-zone who are selected for promotion is always lower than the promotion opportunity. See below...

|           | FY14 | FY15 | FY16 | FY17 | FY18 | FY19 | FY20 | FY21 | FY22 | FY23 | FY24 |
|-----------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| <b>O4</b> | 89%  | 90%  | 93%  | 88%  | 85%  | 87%  | 91%  | 83%  | 91%  | 88%  |      |
| <b>O5</b> | 66%  | 49%  | 53%  | 44%  | 40%  | 52%  | 53%  | 50%  | 50%  | 57%  |      |
| <b>O6</b> | 43%  | 47%  | 39%  | 34%  | 37%  | 41%  | 51%  | 53%  | 60%  | 67%  | 65%  |

**Actual percentage of in-zone Medical Corps candidates selected for promotion.**

Now that you've downloaded the PDFs of your record and understand your timeline, let's get started updating your record.

## AWARDS

The first thing you need to do is ensure that the awards listed on your OSR are accurate. This is where the promotion board will see them, and where promotion board recorders will make updates, as required. If you look on your OSR and your awards are accurate, you are done. Only individual awards at the level of a Navy and Marine Corps Achievement Medal (NAM) or higher will show here. Unit awards are not displayed. For example, here is what mine looks like (of note, I don't have any NAMs):

| PERSONAL DECORATIONS |           |
|----------------------|-----------|
| <b>LGN OF MRT</b>    | <b>01</b> |
| <b>DEF MER SVC</b>   | <b>01</b> |
| <b>MER SVC MDL</b>   | <b>02</b> |
| <b>NAV COM</b>       | <b>04</b> |
| <b>CAR</b>           | <b>01</b> |

If the awards on your OSR are not accurate, you will need to log on to [BOL](#) and follow the instructions on [the awards webpage at Navy Personnel Command](#).

If you are still confused after reading this page, here are my recommendations for simplified and practical steps to take if the awards on your OSR are not correct:

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1. Recognize that the awards section of your OSR is of very little importance unless you have a Combat Action Ribbon, Bronze Star, Purple Heart, or other combat award. It also might be important if you have an award that is atypical for your rank (for example, an O5 with a Legion of Merit) or have fewer awards than one would expect at your rank (an O5 up for O6 with only a NAM). Getting credit for your 3<sup>rd</sup> Navy Commendation is not going to be the difference in whether you do or do not promote.
2. Contact the awards person in your admin shop to see if they can help you fix the issue.
3. If that doesn't work, just send a letter to the promotion board discussing the corrections that are necessary. This won't fix your record permanently, but it will ensure the awards were accurate for that board. Letters are discussed in the last chapter.



## YOUR PSR

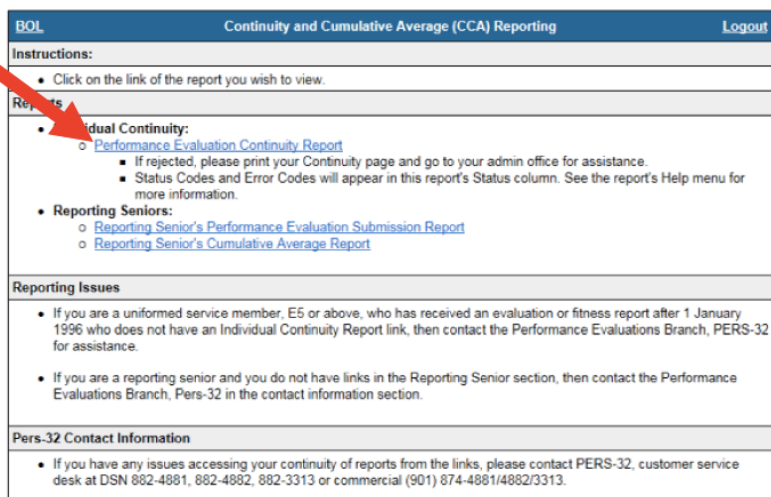
You need to ensure your fitreps are accurate on your PSR. First, make sure there are no gaps in your fitrep continuity. To check on this, logon to [BOL](#).

Next, click on the link entitled “CCA/FITREP/Eval Reports”.



Then click on the link entitled “Performance Evaluation Continuity Report”.

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**BQL** Continuity and Cumulative Average (CCA) Reporting **Logout**

**Instructions:**

- Click on the link of the report you wish to view.

**Reports**

- Individual Continuity:**
  - [Performance Evaluation Continuity Report](#)
    - If rejected, please print your Continuity page and go to your admin office for assistance.
    - Status Codes and Error Codes will appear in this report's Status column. See the report's Help menu for more information.
- Reporting Seniors:**
  - [Reporting Senior's Performance Evaluation Submission Report](#)
  - [Reporting Senior's Cumulative Average Report](#)

**Reporting Issues**

- If you are a uniformed service member, E5 or above, who has received an evaluation or fitness report after 1 January 1996 who does not have an Individual Continuity Report link, then contact the Performance Evaluations Branch, PERS-32 for assistance.
- If you are a reporting senior and you do not have links in the Reporting Senior section, then contact the Performance Evaluations Branch, PERS-32 in the contact information section.

**Pers-32 Contact Information**

- If you have any issues accessing your continuity of reports from the links, please contact PERS-32, customer service desk at DSN 882-4881, 882-4882, 882-3313 or commercial (901) 874-4881/4882/3313.

A report will be generated that lists all of your fitreps and at the bottom of the screen shows you if there are any gaps that you will need to address. As you can see, there are no gaps in my fitreps.

|         |         |      |         |  |            |                |     |          |         |
|---------|---------|------|---------|--|------------|----------------|-----|----------|---------|
| 10MAR01 | 10DEC10 | LCDR | 10MAR01 |  | Concurrent | Detach Ind     | ACT | Purged   | 11SEP01 |
| 10MAR01 | 10DEC10 | LCDR | 10MAR01 |  | Concurrent | Detach Ind     | ACT | Complete | 11SEP09 |
| 10MAY08 | 10OCT31 | LCDR | 09SEP16 |  | Regular    | Periodic       | ACT | Complete | 11JAN06 |
| 10NOV01 | 11SEP22 | LCDR | 09SEP16 |  | Regular    | Detach Rep Sen | ACT | Complete | 11NOV21 |
| 11SEP23 | 12OCT31 | LCDR | 09SEP16 |  | Regular    | Periodic       | ACT | Complete | 12DEC28 |
| 12NOV01 | 13AUG31 | LCDR | 09SEP16 |  | Regular    | Special        | ACT | Complete | 13DEC31 |
| 13SEP01 | 14JUN09 | CDR  | 09SEP16 |  | Regular    | Detach Rep Sen | ACT | Complete | 14AUG04 |
| 14JUN10 | 15APR30 | CDR  | 14JUN12 |  | Regular    | Periodic       | ACT | Complete | 15JUN03 |
| 15MAY01 | 15AUG27 | CDR  | 14JUN12 |  | Regular    | Detach Ind     | ACT | Complete | 15SEP08 |
| 15AUG28 | 16JUN21 | CDR  | 15SEP25 |  | Regular    | Periodic       | ACT | Complete | 16JUN30 |
| 15SEP25 | 16JUN17 | CDR  | 15SEP25 |  | Concurrent | Detach Ind     | ACT | Complete | 16JUN30 |

| From Date                                                                                                                                                                                 | To Date | Grade Rank | Date Reported | Reporting Senior | Report Type | Occasion | Duty Status | Status | Status Date |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------|---------------|------------------|-------------|----------|-------------|--------|-------------|
| <b>Selection Boards</b>                                                                                                                                                                   |         |            |               |                  |             |          |             |        |             |
| No selection boards to display.                                                                                                                                                           |         |            |               |                  |             |          |             |        |             |
| <b>Missing Periods</b>                                                                                                                                                                    |         |            |               |                  |             |          |             |        |             |
| No missing periods to display.                                                                                                                                                            |         |            |               |                  |             |          |             |        |             |
| If you do not know the location of a reporting senior, or need other assistance in resolving these missing periods, contact the Navy Personnel Command Service Center at 1-866-U-ASK-NPC. |         |            |               |                  |             |          |             |        |             |

**BQL | CCA** 8/30/2016 **Help** **Logout**

Focus especially on the last five years of fitreps because that is what the promotion board will focus on. If you have gaps, you can ignore any that are 90 days or less in duration. If you have more than a 90 day gap, you should try to get it addressed, and often you'll just have to send a letter to the promotion board to explain the gap. Old fitrep issues are hard to get fixed.

If there are significant gaps or errors, try to get them corrected by contacting My Navy Career Center at [askmncc@navy.mil](mailto:askmncc@navy.mil) or by phone at 1-833-330-MNCC (1-833-330-6622). Your Detailer cannot fix fitness report issues or

errors themselves.

Sending duplicate fitreps compounds any processing problem that might exist, so it is best to call and check on the report first. If a fitrep is missing from your record, you may have to send a copy signed by the member and the reporting senior to:

Bureau of Naval Personnel  
PERS-32  
5720 Integrity Drive  
Millington, TN 38055-3201

Only do this **AFTER** contacting My Navy Career Center to ensure that they have not already received the report.

If you are just trying to change the dates of a fitrep to close a gap, requests for administrative changes can be requested by letter to PERS-32 (address above). Members can request corrections of obvious errors to blocks 1-19 and blocks 21 to 27 by submitting a letter requesting the corrections to PERS-32. Changes to other blocks on the fitness report **must** be requested by the reporting senior that signed the original report.

If you can't get gaps 90 days or greater corrected before the promotion board, just send a letter to the promotion board to explain them. Procedures for sending a letter to the board are discussed in the last chapter.

One last thing on your PSR...you need to make sure the info recorded on the PSR for your fitreps is accurate. There is no easy way to do this other than to manually review your fitreps, again focusing on the last five years since that is what the promotion board will focus on. All the boxes you need to check and what they mean are explained here:

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MAKE SURE YOUR FITREP TRAITS ARE ACCURATE. FOR EXAMPLE, ON THIS FITREP I GOT FIVE 5'S AND ONE 4. THAT IS WHAT IS RECORDED HERE, SO IT IS ACCURATE.

MY INDIVIDUAL AVERAGE ON THIS FITREP WAS 4.83. THE NUMBER BELOW IT IS THE SUMMARY GROUP AVERAGE. THIS WAS A 1/1 FITREP, SO THE SUMMARY GROUP AVERAGE WAS ALSO 4.83. BOTH NUMBERS ARE ACCURATE.

I GOT AN EP ON THIS FITREP, WHICH IS WHAT IS SHOWN HERE, SO IT IS ACCURATE.

| PG | STATION           | DUTY          | DATES            | M O S | REPORTING SENIOR |    | TRAITS      |   |   |   |   | AVERAGE |              | PROMOTION RECORD |    |    |   |    | RPT TYPE |    |     |
|----|-------------------|---------------|------------------|-------|------------------|----|-------------|---|---|---|---|---------|--------------|------------------|----|----|---|----|----------|----|-----|
|    |                   |               |                  |       | NAME             | PG | TITLE       | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5       | IND SUM      | P/S CUM          | SP | PR | P | MP |          | EP | PRT |
| 05 | NPC MILLINGTON TN | QMC DETAILER  | 050115<br>082715 | 4     |                  | 06 | BRANCH HEAD | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 5       | 4.83<br>4.83 | 14<br>4.46       | 0  | 0  | 0 | 0  | X<br>1   | P  | RG  |
| 05 | ECRC FWD NORFOLK  | GSA FWD       | 082815<br>062116 | 10    |                  | 06 | CO          |   |   |   |   |         | 0.00<br>0.00 | 0<br>0.00        | 0  | 0  | 0 | 0  | 0        |    | RG  |
| 05 | JTF GTMO          | COMMANDER JMG | 092515<br>061716 | 9     |                  | 07 | COMMANDER   | 0 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 4       | 4.67<br>4.67 | 0<br>0.00        | 0  | 0  | 0 | 0  | X<br>1   | P  | CC  |

YOU CAN CHECK THE REST OF IT IF YOU WANT, BUT THESE ARE THE PARTS I'D CHECK IF IT WAS MY RECORD.

FINALLY, CHECK TO MAKE SURE YOUR PFA CODES ARE ACCURATE. I PASSED MY PFA DURING THIS FITREP CYCLE, SO THIS CODE IS ACCURATE.

## ACADEMIC DEGREES

You need to ensure all educational degrees are present on your OSR and are accurate. Here you can see my degrees. They include a BS from 1997 in Exercise & Sports Science from Ursinus College in Pennsylvania, an MD in 2001 from Hahnemann in Pennsylvania, and an MBA in 2014 from Naval Postgraduate School in Monterey.

| EDUCATION         |                     |                 |
|-------------------|---------------------|-----------------|
| COLLEGE           | DATE/LEVEL          | MAJOR           |
| <b>MONTEREY</b>   | <b>14 MASTER</b>    | <b>BUS ADM</b>  |
| <b>HAHNEMN PA</b> | <b>01 DOCTOR</b>    | <b>MEDICINE</b> |
| <b>URSINUS PA</b> | <b>97 BACH/1 PR</b> | <b>SPORTS S</b> |

To have your formal education updated, the official transcripts must come directly from the school to the office below. They can be delivered electronically as long as the school uses a secure delivery system such as eScript/Parchment to [askmncc.fct@navy.mil](mailto:askmncc.fct@navy.mil) or they can be mailed to:

NAVY PERSONNEL COMMAND  
 MNCC  
 BLDG 768 RM E302  
 5720 INTEGRITY DRIVE  
 MILLINGTON, TN 38055

If you are going to send them electronically, please note this caveat from the [PERS website](#):

“Transcripts sent electronically through National Student Clearinghouse must select “Education Organization, Application Service and Scholarships”, “Department of the Navy” and “Navy Personnel Command” in the drop-down menus of the recipient details section. Selecting other options may result in failure to deliver transcripts electronically.”

If you note duplicate degrees on your OSR, you can correct them by contacting My Navy Career Center at [askmncc@navy.mil](mailto:askmncc@navy.mil) or by phone at 1-833-330-6622. I had a duplicate degree, and they fixed it very quickly on my record.

Please also note this Q&A from the [PERS website](#):

**My board is coming up soon and I need to update my record with transcripts. Will my transcripts make it in time?**

Answer: It is recommended that any record update completed within 1 month of your board convening date should also be followed up with a letter to the board with the same information.

AQD CODES

Ensure all of the additional qualification designation codes (AQDs) that you qualify for are in block 72 of your ODC. Here is what mine looks like:

| 72 ADDITIONAL QUAL DESIG |    |              |
|--------------------------|----|--------------|
| CODE YR                  |    | TITLE        |
| 6PG                      | 22 | *EMED ULTSOU |
| 6OW                      | 21 | TRAUMA TEAM  |
| JS8                      | 21 | JPME PHASE2  |
| 6OR                      | 21 | CATF SURGEO  |
| 2D1                      | 20 | CMD ELIGIBL  |
| JS7                      | 17 | JPME PHASE1  |
| J5M                      | 16 | IA JT MED    |
| 2C1                      | 15 | LSS GB CERT  |
| U6O                      | 15 | IA NAV OPS   |
| 6ZC                      | 14 | ASSCPROF     |
| 6ZF                      | 14 | RESRCHER     |
| 67A                      | 11 | EXECUTIVE M  |

Your AQDs feed the “Special Qualifications” section of your OSR, which is what the promotion board will see. They don’t see your ODC.

Here is what my Special Qualifications section looks like. You can see that many reflect the AQDs that I have:

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| SPECIAL QUALIFICATIONS |                        |                       |                         |
|------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|
| 1 <b>XO SHR ACTY</b>   | 7 <b>INTERN</b>        | 13 <b>JPME PHASE1</b> | 19 <b>EXECUTIVE MED</b> |
| 2 <b>MED DPT STF</b>   | 8 <b>EMED ULTSOUND</b> | 14 <b>IA JT MED</b>   | 20 <b>IA JT MED</b>     |
| 3 <b>EMERG MED SPE</b> | 9 <b>TRAUMA TEAM T</b> | 15 <b>LSS GB CERT</b> | 21 <b>SHIPBD 17</b>     |
| 4 <b>PERS DIST OFF</b> | 10 <b>CATF SURGEON</b> | 16 <b>IA NAV OPS</b>  | 22 <b>GM FMF</b>        |
| 5 <b>HS RES</b>        | 11 <b>JPME PHASE2</b>  | 17 <b>RESRCHER</b>    | 23                      |
| 6 <b>GP MED</b>        | 12 <b>CMD ELIGIBLE</b> | 18 <b>ASSCPROF</b>    | 24                      |

The other way that this Special Qualifications section gets populated is the billets you occupy. For example, there is no AQD for "PERS DIST OFF" (short for Personnel Distribution Officer). To get this qualification you must have resided in a Detailer billet for 6 months.

To see which AQDs you qualify for, go to [this blog page](#) for a list of all medical AQDs. The list of non-medical AQDs is more than 600 pages long, and may be found on [this blog page](#).

To make life easier for us and to prevent most physicians from having to look through 600+ pages to make sure they have every AQD they qualify for, I did a study of every Naval physician in December 2014 and looked at their non-medical AQDs. While you can obviously still go through all 600+ pages if you want, the list of non-medical AQDs that physicians often qualify for includes:

| <b>AQD CODE</b> | <b>NAME</b>                                   | <b>REQUIREMENT</b>                                                                                                |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LA7             | Surface Warfare Medical Department Officer    | Officer who has qualified as a Surface Warfare Medical Department Officer IAW OPNAVINST 1412.8.                   |
| BX2             | Fleet Marine Force (FMF) Warfare Officer      | Qualified as a Fleet Marine Force Warfare Officer (FMFWO) IAW current fleet instructions and SECNAVINST 1412.10.  |
| U6O             | Operations Intra Service IA                   | Successfully completed assignment to an Individual Augmentation (Intra Service) for a minimum period of 6 months. |
| U4M             | Fleet/Division Staff Medical Intra Service IA | Successfully completed assignment to an Individual Augmentation (Intra Service) for a minimum period of 6 months. |
| U6M             | Other Medical Intra Service IA                | Successfully completed assignment to an Individual Augmentation (Intra Service) for a minimum period of 6         |



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|     |                                      |                                                                                                                                        |
|-----|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|     |                                      | months.                                                                                                                                |
| BT1 | Static-Line Qualified Parachutist    | Officer who is qualified IAW MILPERSMAN 1220-030.                                                                                      |
| QK1 | Naval Special Warfare Experience     | Non-SEAL/SWCC Officer who completes 15 months or more service in a qualifying Naval Special Warfare billet.                            |
| J6M | Other Medical IA                     | Successfully completed assignment to an Individual Augmentation (Interservice Interagency Coalition) for a minimum period of 6 months. |
| J4M | Fleet/Division Staff Medical IA      | Successfully completed assignment to an Individual Augmentation (Interservice Interagency Coalition) for a minimum period of 6 months. |
| J5M | Joint Task Force Medical IA          | Successfully completed assignment to an Individual Augmentation (Interservice Interagency Coalition) for a minimum period of 6 months. |
| J3M | Combatant Commander Level Medical IA | Successfully completed assignment to an Individual Augmentation (Interservice Interagency Coalition) for a minimum period of 6 months. |
| DZQ | Joint Air Operations                 | Course completion: Aviation Safety Officer course.                                                                                     |

Once you have a list of medical AQDs you qualify for, e-mail the three letter codes, the year you qualified, and “proof” that you qualify for them (letters, fitreps, transcripts, certificates, etc.) to your Detailer. He/she will add them to your record. Non-medical AQDs, such as those from a prior career as a line officer, are to be referred to that community’s Placement Officer. You’ll have to try and find them by going to each community’s page, which you can find along the left side of [this page](#). Perhaps your Detailer could help you out as well.

As an aside, **please try to put all of this info into one e-mail to your Detailer.** Detailers get a ton of e-mail, and it is much appreciated if all of the AQDs you want added can be wrapped up into one nice, tidy e-mail package.

**Note #1** - If you have done Joint Professional Military Education (JPME) I or II and are looking to add the JS7 (JPME I) or JS8 (JPME II) AQDs, here

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are the instructions to use because Detailers cannot add these AQDs:

Except for the "in-residence" military programs, you must provide us with your official JPME completion letter/diploma for all accredited programs to receive your respective AQD (JPME I - JS7, JPME II - JS8). Send your documentation for all distance learning programs to the appropriate email address below. Please redact all PII information. Documents are processed daily, however, you will not receive a reply that your email was received.

AC and FTS: [AC\\_JQS\\_Manager@navy.mil](mailto:AC_JQS_Manager@navy.mil)  
SELRES: [Mill\\_RC\\_JQS\\_Manager@navy.mil](mailto:Mill_RC_JQS_Manager@navy.mil)

Your AQD will be entered in the Joint Manpower Information System, and Officer Assignment Information System within 30 days.

**Note #2** - When it comes to AQDs, in my experience there are only a few that people mention when briefing a record at the promotion board. The ones mentioned are JPME I and II and any that represent a warfare pin or deployment. Outside of these, rarely do AQDs get mentioned. If you are looking to maximize your impact, spend your time getting JPME and your respective operational AQDs and ignore the rest of them.

## SUBSPECIALTY CODES

You need to make sure that your record accurately reflects your board certification, training status, and specialties. On your OSR under “Education” is a section called “SUB-SPEC.” Here is mine:

| SUB-SPEC                     |
|------------------------------|
| <b>16P1J</b><br><b>16P0K</b> |

In this section are very cryptic codes that indicate what specialties you are trained in and whether you are board certified. The codes are listed below, and anything you are board certified in should end in the letter “K.” If it ends in “J” it means you are trained but not board certified. If it ends in a “T” it means you are in training for that specialty, like a residency or fellowship program.

|      |                                 |
|------|---------------------------------|
| 15A0 | Flight Surgery                  |
| 15A1 | Residency in Aerospace Medicine |

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|      |                                   |
|------|-----------------------------------|
| 15B0 | Anesthesia, General               |
| 15B1 | Anesthesia, Subspecialty          |
| 15C0 | Surgery, General                  |
| 15C1 | Surgery, Subspecialty             |
| 15D0 | Neurosurgery, General             |
| 15D1 | Neurosurgery, Subspecialty        |
| 15E0 | OB/GYN, General                   |
| 15E1 | OB/GYN, Subspecialty              |
| 15F0 | General Medical Officer           |
| 15G0 | Ophthalmology, General            |
| 15G1 | Ophthalmology, Subspecialty       |
| 15H0 | Orthopedics, General              |
| 15H1 | Orthopedics, Subspecialty         |
| 15I0 | ENT, General                      |
| 15I1 | ENT, Subspecialty                 |
| 15J0 | Urology, General                  |
| 15J1 | Urology, Subspecialty             |
| 15K0 | Preventive Medicine, General      |
| 15K1 | Preventive Medicine, Subspecialty |
| 15K2 | Occupational Medicine             |
| 15L0 | PM&R, General                     |
| 15L1 | PM&R, Subspecialty                |
| 15M0 | Pathology, General                |
| 15M1 | Pathology, Subspecialty           |
| 16N0 | Dermatology, General              |
| 16N1 | Dermatology, Subspecialty         |
| 16P0 | Emergency Medicine, General       |
| 16P1 | Emergency Medicine, Subspecialty  |
| 16Q0 | Family Medicine, General          |
| 16Q1 | Family Medicine, Subspecialty     |
| 16R0 | Internal Medicine, General        |
| 16R1 | Internal Medicine, Subspecialty   |
| 16T0 | Neurology, General                |
| 16T1 | Neurology, Subspecialty           |

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|      |                                 |
|------|---------------------------------|
| 16U0 | Undersea Medicine, General      |
| 16U1 | Undersea Medicine, Subspecialty |
| 16V0 | Pediatrics, General             |
| 16V1 | Pediatrics, Subspecialty        |
| 16W0 | Nuclear Medicine                |
| 16X0 | Psychiatry, General             |
| 16X1 | Psychiatry, Subspecialty        |
| 16Y0 | Radiology, General              |
| 16Y1 | Radiology, Subspecialty         |
| 16Y2 | Radiation Oncology              |

Using the above chart, you can see that my 16P0K is because I am board certified in Emergency Medicine. If I was in Emergency Medicine residency, my code would be 16P0T. My 16P1J is because I am fellowship trained in a subspecialty (Emergency Ultrasound) for which there is no board certification (which is why it ends in a "J"). When I was in fellowship, it would have been 16P1T.

To fix any of these subspecialty codes you have to e-mail Mr. Anthony Frabutt at [Anthony.W.Frabutt.civ@health.mil](mailto:Anthony.W.Frabutt.civ@health.mil).

Make sure that if you are board certified in a specialty that **AT LEAST ONE OF YOUR SUBSPECIALTY CODES ENDS IN A "K"**. If you don't, the promotion board may not be sure if you are board certified, and this is a pretty big box to check if you want to be competitive for promotion to O5 and O6. It comes up at just about every promotion board.

## SERVICE SCHOOLS

Make sure the service schools listed on your OSR are accurate and up to date. Only six service schools will fit on your OSR. Here is what mine look like:

| SERVICE SCHOOLS ATTENDED |              |    |             |    |
|--------------------------|--------------|----|-------------|----|
| COURSE:                  | ADV LDRSH    | XO | JCWS        |    |
| DATE/WEEKS:              | 2202         | 02 | 2103        | 12 |
| COURSE:                  | PCO/PXO MIL  | JU | IIFHCE      |    |
| DATE/WEEKS:              | 2202         | 00 | 1709        | 02 |
| COURSE:                  | CATF SURGEON |    | PCO/PXO MIL | JU |
| DATE/WEEKS:              | 2103         | 02 | 1709        | 01 |

To see a list of service schools, go to [this blog page](#). **No matter how important you think a class is, if it is not a service school it cannot be added to the OSR.**

To add a service school to the OSR, the three-digit service school code, course abbreviation, completion date, and duration (weeks or “cc” if correspondence course) are required. The course completion certificate and this information must be sent to My Navy Career Center at [askmncc@navy.mil](mailto:askmncc@navy.mil).

You will know they have received your request because you’ll get an e-mail from them and follow-on e-mails updating you on the status of your request.

Going to the website below may be one stop shopping to obtain “proof” of

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your prior training as you can download a PDF copy of your training transcript:

<https://jst.doded.mil/jst/>

## SECURITY CLEARANCE

If your security clearance is expired, your name may be pulled off the promotion list after the board adjourns. To check on its status, you will need to go to your Security Manager. Under the old system, security clearances would expire at various intervals (Secret in 10 years, Top Secret in 5 years), but we've now moved to a continuous review system.

If it was up to me, I'd still double check there were no issues with my clearance before I was coming in zone.



## OFFICIAL PHOTO

Official photos were historically displayed in promotion boards. Then in 2016 they stopped displaying them, they came back in 2019, and then went away again in 2020. While no longer displayed in the promotion board, the requirement still exists that you have an official photo in your current rank in your OMPF. Usually you just go to Medical Photo at a military treatment facility to get one taken.

Once you have the photo, officers now have the option of uploading their photo to their OMPF electronically:

- Go to BOL and log in with your CAC card
- Select “Navy Personnel Command Document Services”
- Select “NAVPERS 1070/884 Officer Photograph Form” in the light grey menu
- Fill in the form and upload the photo

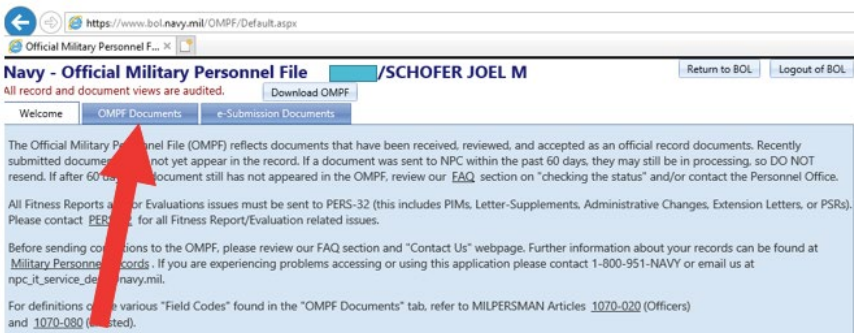
I did this and it took 24 hours for the photo to appear in my OMPF.

To verify the photograph has been entered into the permanent record, log into OMPF via BOL:

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Click on “OMPF Documents”:



Click on the document name to see it:



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## LETTERS TO THE BOARD

If you are reading this, you are likely a busy medical professional. You have better things to do than try repeatedly to fix your record. My general advice is to try fixing an issue twice. If after two attempts it is still not fixed, just send a letter to the board explaining that you tried to fix your record but could not. This won't fix your record permanently and you'll still have an incorrect record after the board, but it will keep you sane and ensure that your record was correct for that specific board.

### **When Should You Send A Letter to the Promotion Board?**

You should send a letter to the promotion board if:

- You are reporting to a new command, you will not receive a fitrep before the promotion board meets, and your Commanding Officer is willing to write a letter about your contributions to your new command.
- You have issues in your record or career that require explanation or amplifying information. For example, you want to tell the promotion board how promotion will allow you to do something you can't do at your present rank, like screen for XO. If there are any gaps of more than 90 days in

your military service or any new information not on your fitreps, these may need explanation as well.

- You have to make corrections/additions to your record (like missing or illegible fitreps, awards, academic or professional achievements, etc.) but you either don't have time to update them the standard way or you have tried without success.
- If you have been passed over for promotion at least once and you have testimonial letters from someone who can comment positively on your performance. In general, you should try to get letters from the most senior member who knows you well enough to discuss your contributions to the Navy and why you should get promoted. For example, it is probably better to get a letter from an O6 who knows you well than to get a letter from an O8 who does not. Also, your Commanding Officer usually should not write a letter if he/she has done a fitrep on you as his/her opinion should be reflected in the fitrep, although it is ultimately up to them. Your Specialty Leader is always a solid choice as a letter writer.

When writing letters to the board, keep the following in mind:

- They are usually not recommended unless there is a reason to send a letter listed above. Do not send one just for the fun of it.
- Keep it to a minimum - one page or less - as boards have to read everything sent to them and they are very busy.
- Do not send copies of publications.
- Only the service member can send the letter on his/her behalf. In other words, if you have a letter from an admiral, you need to send it to the board. Don't have the admiral's aide send it to the board directly. It will not be considered by the board.
- By law, a letter to the board must be considered. In other words, if you don't want the board to discuss a topic, don't mention it in a letter. If there is adverse information in your record, sending a letter discussing it may help if you have

amplifying information to add. Then again, if it is something they might not have noticed, sending a letter discussing it ensures that they will notice it!

- If you do have something adverse, I usually recommend you ignore it the first time you are in zone. If you don't promote, the next time I'd try to explain your side of the story and see what happens. If you don't promote the second time, I'd just alternate between ignoring it and sending a letter about it. If you wanted to reverse those and explain it the first time but ignore it the second time, that is probably fine too. It really is up to you how you want to handle it, and there is no obviously correct answer.
- Your letter must arrive no later than 10 days before the board convenes. This requirement has been around for a few years now. You used to be able to send letters right up until midnight the night before.

For an example letter to the board, see [this website](#) and click on "Sample Letter to the Board" on the right side of the page. It tells you how to prepare and submit your letter.

## ABOUT THE AUTHOR

CAPT Joel Schofer is board certified in Emergency Medicine and currently serves as the Deputy Commander of NMRTC Portsmouth and the Deputy Director of Naval Medical Center Portsmouth. He is a recovering Detailer, Specialty Leader, and Deputy Medical Corps Chief, but is mostly known as “the guy with the blog” (MCCareer.org). He is a Certified Physician Executive, has over 200 professional publications and presentations, has held numerous national and state leadership positions, and has won national academic and educational awards. He holds an academic appointment as an Associate Professor of Military and Emergency Medicine at the Uniformed Services University of the Health Sciences. He is a Fellow in the American Academy of Emergency Medicine and American Association for Physician Leadership. His military decorations include the Combat Action Ribbon, a Legion of Merit, a Defense Meritorious Service Medal, two Meritorious Service Medals, and four Navy and Marine Corps Commendation Medals.